Week 3 Assignment: Jargon-to-Plain-English Clinic

Name:
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Passage 1: Rewrite

Our top priority now is to fix the client's login bug before Friday. The bug is blocking three other tasks, so we should deal with it immediately. Because the client is unhappy, we must use our full team capacity this week. We already tried two quick fixes, but neither worked. Tomorrow morning, the whole team will meet briefly to agree on the next steps. This should be a simple fix, but we keep finding new problems. Once we find the root cause, we plan to examine the server logs together in detail. After that, we will follow up with the client and start work on the next update right away. Please reply to me with your progress by 5 p.m. today. If we stay aligned and move quickly, we can close this ticket by tomorrow.

Soon, we plan to fix two more small bugs in the same module. The second bug looks easy, so it should not take long to fix. We still do not know why the server keeps crashing every night. The new intern offered to take over this bug while the senior developer is on leave. Tomorrow morning, another engineer will log in to the system to check the crash logs. We hope these small fixes will noticeably reduce the number of daily crashes. The client has asked for practical advice on why this keeps happening. Our aim is to improve the whole server setup, not just patch one small part of it. This extra work will also benefit the client, since it may prevent future problems. We should finish it on time and keep everyone informed.

The team finally found the real cause of the crash late last night. We are writing a permanent fix instead of another quick patch. Normally, we test every fix twice before sending it to the client. Because this bug affected several clients, we plan to test even more carefully this time. We will run on the new server for one full day before we call it stable. After that, the team will go ahead with deployment to all remaining clients. This fix covers all of our main deliverables for this sprint, not just the login page. Our manager called it a complete solution and a major improvement for the support team. The new system handles growth better and runs on a stronger framework than the old one. This fix should raise the quality of our whole product, and the team is ready to start the next project right away.

Passage 1: Glossary

Original	Plain English	Why
at this point in time / at this juncture	now / still	wordy phrase
creating a bottleneck for	blocking	cliché
look after this issue	deal with it	wrong phrasal verb ("look after" means care for)
due to the fact that / on account of the fact that	because	wordy phrase
leverage our full team bandwidth	use our full team capacity	jargon
it is important to note that / it should be noted that	(deleted)	filler
touch base and get on the same page	meet briefly and agree	cliché
for all intents and purposes	(deleted)	filler
deep dive into	examine in detail	jargon

Original	Plain English	Why
circle back with	follow up with	jargon
hit the ground running	start right away / move quickly	cliché
revert back to me	reply to me	misused ("revert" means return to a previous state) and redundant
in the near future	soon	wordy phrase
low-hanging fruit	easy task	cliché
take after this bug	take over this bug	wrong phrasal verb ("take after" means resemble)
enter into the system	log in to the system	wrong phrasal verb
move the needle	noticeably reduce	cliché
with reference to the above	(deleted)	filler
actionable insights	practical advice	jargon
optimize the whole server ecosystem	improve the whole server setup	jargon
value-add	benefit	jargon
in a timely manner	on time	wordy phrase
in the process of writing	writing	wordy phrase
as a general rule	normally	wordy phrase
put up with	run on	wrong phrasal verb ("put up with" means tolerate)
continue on with	go ahead with	redundant
end-to-end solution	complete solution	jargon
game-changer	major improvement	cliché
scalable / robust	handles growth / strong	jargon
take to the next-level	raise the quality of	cliché

Passage 2: Rewrite

Our team held its annual planning meeting to discuss this year's plan. Our main goal is to work better with the marketing department. Because the last product launch was slow, we must do better this time. We agreed on five new action items and shared them with all the key stakeholders. On hiring, we should check with the HR team before posting any new job. Everyone agreed to try new ideas and test a few new marketing approaches this quarter. However, we should not risk everything on one idea by spending our full budget on it. Next, the design team will study customer feedback in detail and review our core strengths. We should reduce our travel costs so that we can spend more on this project. If everyone keeps trying new ideas and spreads the budget across several of them, this plan can succeed.

Later, the whole team met again to review our new marketing plan. At that time, everyone agreed that we needed a mindset focused on learning and growth. Our manager described this as a small change in how the marketing team thinks. Let's review the budget numbers together before we plan the next campaign. From now on, we also want more support from the sales department. A team drawn from several departments will work faster than one department alone. We should increase our social media budget slightly to support this plan. Everyone agreed on one clear main goal for this quarter: more repeat customers. The whole team is trying to come up with fresh ideas while planning these new campaigns.

As for sales, the new plan already looks promising after just two weeks. We have already found one easy win: a simple change to our email subject lines. Overall, we needed to explain our value to customers more clearly. Because our old website was slow, we lost several new customers last month. The design team studied a few good practices from other companies in our field. Sadly, two members left the project team this month. Mostly, the client understood why we had to postpone the product launch by two weeks. Our head of marketing now wants more expert-led content on our blog and social pages. Talking to real customers helped us understand their problems and reach customers in new cities. This project taught us, once again, not to risk everything on one approach.

Passage 2: Glossary

Original	Plain English	Why
at the present moment in time / at that particular point in time	now / at that time	wordy phrase
annual alignment meeting	annual planning meeting	vague jargon
needless to say / it goes without saying	(deleted)	filler
synergize better with	work better with	jargon
in light of the fact that / by virtue of the fact that	because	wordy phrase
take it to the next level	do better	cliché
key stakeholders	everyone involved	jargon
with regard to the matter of	on	wordy phrase
look up to the HR team	check with the HR team	wrong phrasal verb ("look up to" means admire)
think outside the box	try new ideas	cliché
put all our eggs in one basket	risk everything on one idea	cliché
drill down into	study in detail	jargon
core competencies	core strengths	jargon

Original	Plain English	Why
lower down / raise up	reduce / increase	redundant
in due course	later	wordy phrase
growth mindset	mindset focused on learning and growth	jargon
paradigm shift	change in how the team thinks	jargon
get over the budget numbers	review the budget numbers	wrong phrasal verb ("get over" means recover from)
on a going-forward basis	from now on	wordy phrase
buy-in	support	jargon
cross-functional team	team from several departments	jargon
north star	main goal	cliché
as far as sales are concerned	as for sales	wordy phrase
quick win	easy win	jargon
in the final analysis / for the most part	overall / mostly	wordy phrase
value proposition	value to customers	jargon
best practices	good practices	jargon
exit out of	leave	redundant
call on the product launch	postpone the product launch	wrong phrasal verb ("call on" means visit or ask)
thought leadership content	expert-led content	jargon
pain points	problems	jargon
grow our footprint	reach customers	cliché

Passage 3: Rewrite

Your report shows good effort, but a few sections still need work. If you have time before Friday, please add more practical feedback for the sales team. For clarity, please explain your data in more detail in section three. As mentioned, the client wants us to simplify the entire onboarding process. Please check these figures again, since two of the numbers do not match the original file. We also expect added value in your final recommendations, not just a summary of the data. Try to take a broader approach and think about every point where customers interact with us, not just the sales numbers. Our team regularly reviews these reports together before sending them to the client. Please send the corrected file back to me by Monday morning. The next step is yours now, and this report reflects your own hard work. Let's discuss it again tomorrow.

Please send the revised report as soon as you can, ideally before Wednesday. To make sure the numbers are correct, please check them one more time. Could you please read through the introduction once more before you send it back to me? For the third section, try to compare our results against a clear standard. Because this report will go to senior management, please keep the key takeaways short and clear. Using more data in section two will also make your argument stronger. Try to make your final chart look more professional and of the highest quality. Please combine the two small tables into one, since they show similar numbers. Make your suggestions more practical, so the team knows exactly what to do next. A few small changes will polish your report and make it much stronger.

Your revised report is much clearer than the first draft. Usually, small changes like these make a big difference to the reader. Please look again at the conclusion and check the last two sentences carefully. Your new chart has far more impact than the old one. Your writing also feels more focused on the reader now, since you explain things from the client's point of view. Overall, this report shows that you can improve quickly based on feedback. Please add up all the final numbers before you send this to the client. Your recommendations are now more focused on value and results than before. This report also shows a clearer strategic direction for the whole project. The next step is yours one last time, so please send the final file by tomorrow.

Passage 3: Glossary

Original	Plain English	Why
at the end of the day	(deleted)	cliché filler
in the event that	if	wordy phrase
actionable feedback / actionable	practical feedback / practical	jargon
for the purpose of clarity	for clarity	wordy phrase
more granular level	more detail	jargon
as previously mentioned above	as mentioned	redundant
streamline	simplify	jargon
check up these figures	check these figures	wrong phrasal verb ("check up" needs "on")
value addition	added value	jargon
holistic approach	broader approach	jargon
customer touchpoints	points where customers interact with us	jargon
on a regular basis	regularly	wordy phrase
return back	send back	redundant
the ball is in your court	the next step is yours	cliché

Original	Plain English	Why
at your earliest convenience	as soon as you can	wordy phrase
in order to ensure	to make sure	wordy phrase
go off the introduction	read through the introduction	wrong phrasal verb ("go off" means explode or leave)
with respect to	for	wordy phrase
owing to the fact that	because	wordy phrase
benchmark	standard	jargon
data-driven approach	using more data	jargon
best-in-class	of the highest quality	jargon
combine together	combine	redundant
as things currently stand	(deleted)	wordy phrase
in the majority of cases	usually	wordy phrase
look for the conclusion	look again at the conclusion	wrong phrasal verb ("look for" means search for)
it is worth mentioning that	(deleted)	filler
impactful	has more impact	vague jargon
user-centric	focused on the reader	jargon
on the whole	overall	wordy phrase
iterate	improve	jargon
add up together	add up	redundant
value-driven and results-oriented	focused on value and results	jargon

Passage 4: Rewrite

India's AI conversation has mostly focused on large enterprises and very large cloud companies using large language models (LLMs) on cloud-based systems. But a far bigger opportunity lies in the country's more than 60 million small and medium businesses (SMBs). Together, these firms contribute nearly a third of India's GDP and form the backbone of the economy. Despite this scale, AI adoption among SMBs remains limited, held back by scattered IT systems, limited ability to connect software through APIs (the links that let programs share data), and the belief that advanced AI is only for organisations with deep pockets and dedicated data science teams.

Tata Communications and Tata Tele-Business Services (TTBS) now hope to close this gap. Rather than launching another stand-alone application, the two companies are presenting their collaboration as one shared AI platform that many businesses can use at the same time. It is built on scalable cloud computing and edge connectivity (computing and networks placed close to the user), and it aims to make enterprise-grade AI infrastructure cheaper and easier for smaller businesses to use, helping them grow efficiently.

For many SMBs, the real problem has never been recognising AI's potential. It has been managing deployment, since businesses often have to deal with several vendors for connectivity, cloud infrastructure, data-sovereignty compliance and customer engagement tools. Integration costs, delays in response time and the need for specialised technical skills often outweigh the perceived benefits, slowing adoption.

The first visible result of the partnership is an AI-powered Voice Agent platform, hosted on a dedicated AI cloud and powered by the companies' own conversational AI engine. It lets businesses deploy agents that understand and respond in natural language and can answer enquiries, schedule appointments and process orders easily. Unlike older interactive voice response (IVR) phone menus, these agents convert speech to text and text back to speech to hold natural conversations with customers, and they are available 24 hours a day without human involvement.

Finally, executives describe the partnership as a rare, major breakthrough, arguing that access to robust network infrastructure and fast-responding computing power may soon matter as much as access to the AI models themselves. Whether this vision comes true will depend on execution, affordability, and how quickly SMBs become comfortable trusting new digital technology.

Passage 4: Glossary

Original	Plain English	Why
for the most part	mostly	wordy phrase
hyperscalers	very large cloud companies	jargon
cloud-native infrastructure	cloud-based systems	jargon
bigger and greater / more than over	bigger / more than	redundant
lie / contributes / comprises	lies / contribute / form	grammar and word choice ("comprises" is misused here)
fragmented IT infrastructure	scattered IT systems	jargon
API integration capabilities	ability to connect software through APIs	jargon, explained
looking forward to close	hope to close	wrong phrasal verb and grammar
multi-tenant	shared by many businesses at once	technical jargon
scalable, edge connectivity	explained in brackets	jargon

Original	Plain English	Why
to grow and to scale efficiently and effectively	grow efficiently	redundant
conundrum	problem	unnecessary formal word
recognising and identifying	recognising	redundant
deployment orchestration	managing deployment	jargon
traverse multiple different vendors	deal with several vendors	wordy
connectivity provisioning	connectivity	jargon
latency issues	delays in response time	jargon
really specialised / almost frequently	specialised / often	redundant, wrong adverb
outcome and result	result	redundant
proprietary conversational AI engine	the companies' own conversational AI engine	jargon
capable of and able to handle	can answer	redundant
with relative ease and without much difficulty	easily	redundant
leverage speech-to-text and text-to-speech pipelines and processes	convert speech to text and text back to speech	jargon, redundant
around the clock, 24 hours a day / without human intervention whatsoever	24 hours a day / without human involvement	redundant
in the end	finally	wordy phrase
game-changer that happens once in a blue moon	rare, major breakthrough	mixed clichés
low-latency compute / model architectures	fast-responding computing power / AI models	jargon
materialises off	comes true	wrong phrasal verb
putting their trust up into	trusting	wrong phrasal verb
digital transformation technology	new digital technology	jargon

Passage 5: Rewrite

A Chinese startup called Linkerbot is working on one of robotics' biggest problems: building dexterous robotic hands with many independently moving joints. Founded in 2023 by CEO Alex Zhou, the Beijing-based company builds five-fingered robotic hands with touch sensors and motors that let humanoid robots grasp objects, tighten screws and, eventually, do household chores like cooking and cleaning.

Copying the human hand, with its fine control, adjustable grip strength and sensory feedback, is extremely difficult, industry insiders say. Even Tesla's Optimus struggles with hand dexterity, although its legs work fine. Zhou believes that combining artificial intelligence with China's manufacturing strength will finally close this technology gap.

Linkerbot has raised a large amount of money, closing a Series B+ funding round in April that valued it at $3 billion, a huge sum for such a young company. Zhou is now seeking a $6 billion valuation, which would make him a billionaire almost overnight, and investors are lining up to take part.

The company's competitive advantage is low cost, because Linkerbot makes almost all of its components in-house. From motor assembly to sensor calibration, it can undercut rivals such as Singapore's Sharpa and London's Shadow Robot by a wide margin. Zhou insists that economies of scale will bring the hardware cost down to under $100 per pair within three years, a price that would sharply undercut rivals.

Analysts warn, however, that the robotic-hands sector could slide into a race to the bottom, which is called "involution" in China, as competitors cut prices to stay in the market. Some fear the industry could take on more than it can handle, mass-producing hands faster than the underlying AI and motor technology can keep up. Whether Linkerbot can stay afloat while scaling to 100,000 units a year and improving how many independent joint movements its hands can make remains to be seen.

Passage 5: Glossary

Original	Plain English	Why
are cooking up a solution	is working on a solution ("is", since Linkerbot is one company)	cliché and grammar
biggest headaches	biggest problems	cliché
multi-degree-of-freedom	with many independently moving joints	jargon
actuator motors	motors	jargon
reverse-engineering	copying	jargon
herculean task	extremely difficult	cliché
reckons	believes	informal
manufacturing muscle	manufacturing strength	cliché
once and for all	finally	cliché
massive amounts of capital	a large amount of money	jargon
eye-watering sum	huge sum	cliché
overnight, so to speak	almost overnight	filler
lining out to put in on the action	lining up to take part	wrong phrasal verbs
competitive hedge, redundantly speaking	competitive advantage	wrong word ("hedge" means protection) and filler
nearly almost all	almost all	redundant
vertically integrates ... in-house	makes ... in-house	jargon

Original	Plain English	Why
bring downwards ... down	bring down	redundant
bill of materials	hardware cost	jargon
benchmark / undercut off	price / undercut	jargon, wrong phrasal verb
race to the bottom	kept, with a short explanation	idiom, clarified
stay put in the game	stay in the market	wrong phrasal verb and cliché
biting off more than it can swallow	take on more than it can handle	garbled idiom
keep on up with	keep up with	wrong phrasal verb
keep its head above the water	stay afloat	garbled idiom
degrees-of-freedom benchmarks	how many independent joint movements its hands can make	jargon
remains to be saw	remains to be seen	grammar